compromise. He does whatever it takes to get the job done, but always in the name of the greater good. But S.H.I.E.L.D.'s latest preemptive endeavor–Project Insight–has increased surveillance of innocents around the world via three new Helicarriers and a network of targeting satellites, and Steve Rogers begins to suspect the agency he works for has overstepped its bounds. As Tony Stark pointed out in *Marvel's The Avengers*, Nick Fury isn't just a spy. "He is *the* spy. His secrets have secrets."

S.H.I.E.L.D.'s methods infringe on the very freedoms for which Captain America stands. But it isn't until Fury is targeted for assassination that Captain America realizes that S.H.I.E.L.D. has been compromised at its very heart. What had been a complex network of moral ambiguity is now clearly tainted with corruption. Captain America fights for freedom, but how can he fight an enemy he can't even identify? His moral conundrum tangles him within a web of intrigue and deceit; alongside Black Widow, the sentinel of liberty becomes a fugitive in a world of conspiracy.

"Our first Captain America film was a World War II picture," Feige says. "In this one, we tip our hat to the political thrillers of the '70s like *Three Days of the Condor, The Parallax View* and *All the President's Men*–but it's also a contemporary action film."

Marvel's recent *Captain America* comic books had already set a precedent for an espionage thriller.

"The Ed Brubaker/Steve Epting run is definitely a huge inspiration for this film," Moore says. "It was an amazing run."

Writer Ed Brubaker was already known for his crime-fiction comic-book work before he began writing super-hero comics. He relaunched *Captain America* with artist Steve Epting in 2004 and stayed on the series for eight years.



Steve Rogers–the once and future Captain America–from *Steve Rogers: Super-Soldier (2010) #1,* by Dale Eaglesham with colors by Andy Troy.

"I was trying to do something that felt like a tense international political thriller–but with A.I.M., Hydra, Captain America, and S.H.I.E.L.D. instead of the FBI and terrorists," Brubaker says. "I wanted to put that tone into the Marvel Universe, sort of like what Steranko did with Nick Fury and Captain America back in the '60s."

Writer/artist Jim Steranko had been instrumental in the 1960s evolution of Marvel's comic-book style. Most notably in the pages of *Nick Fury, Agent of S.H.I.E.L.D.* and *Captain America*, Steranko introduced